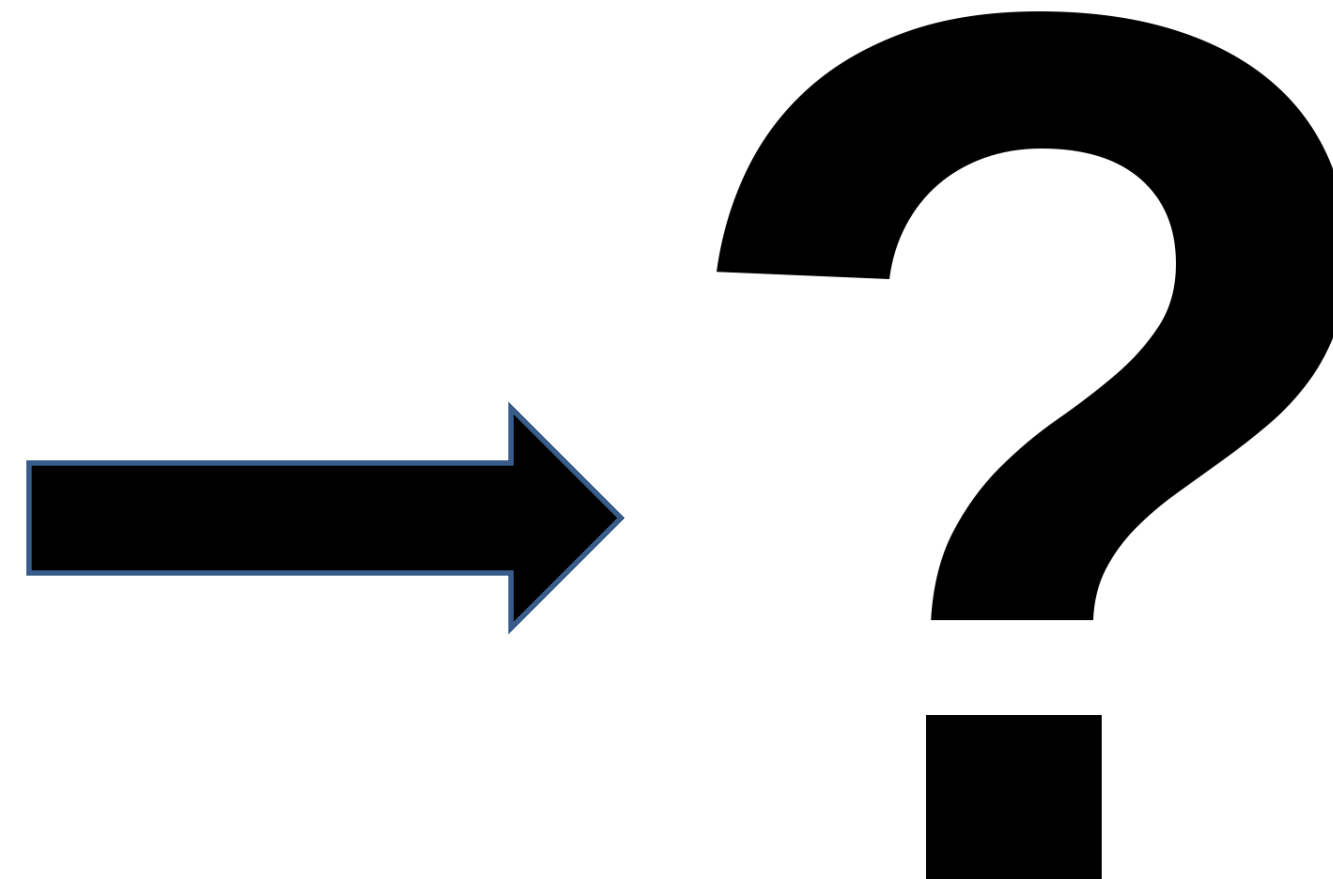
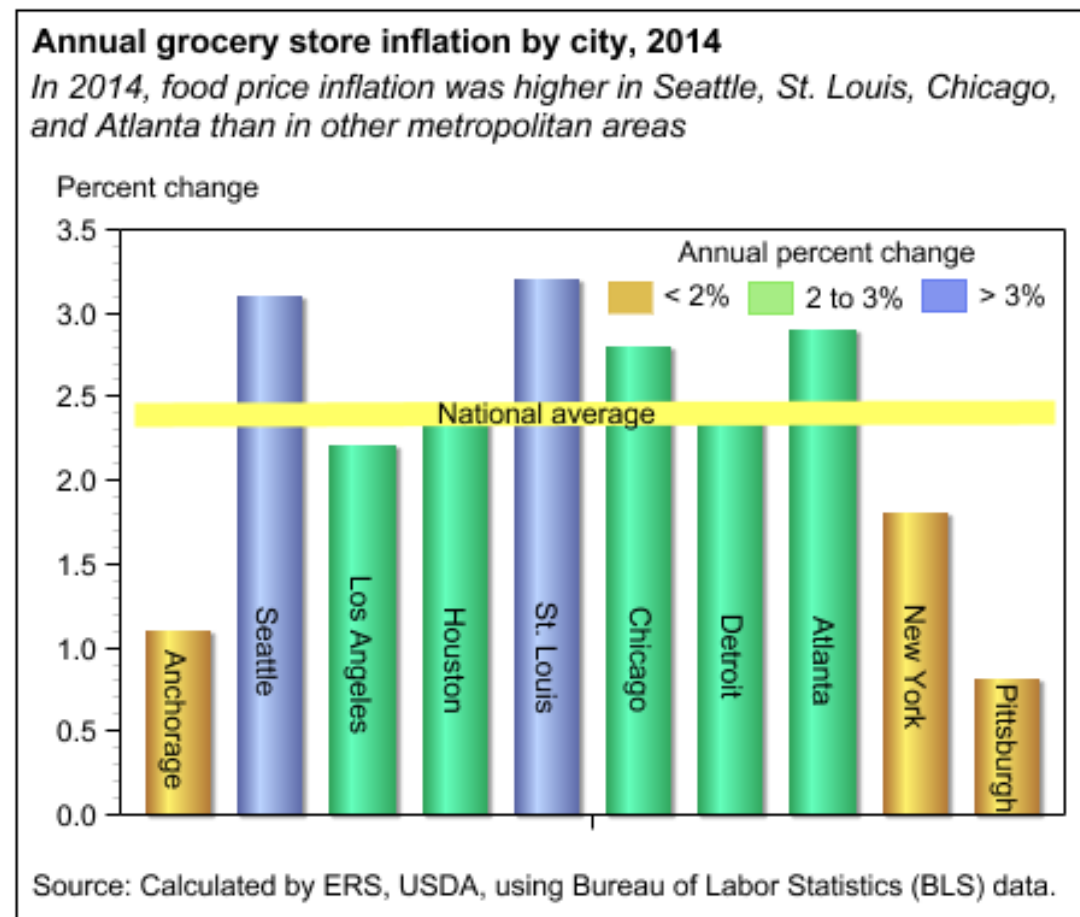


Effective data visualization

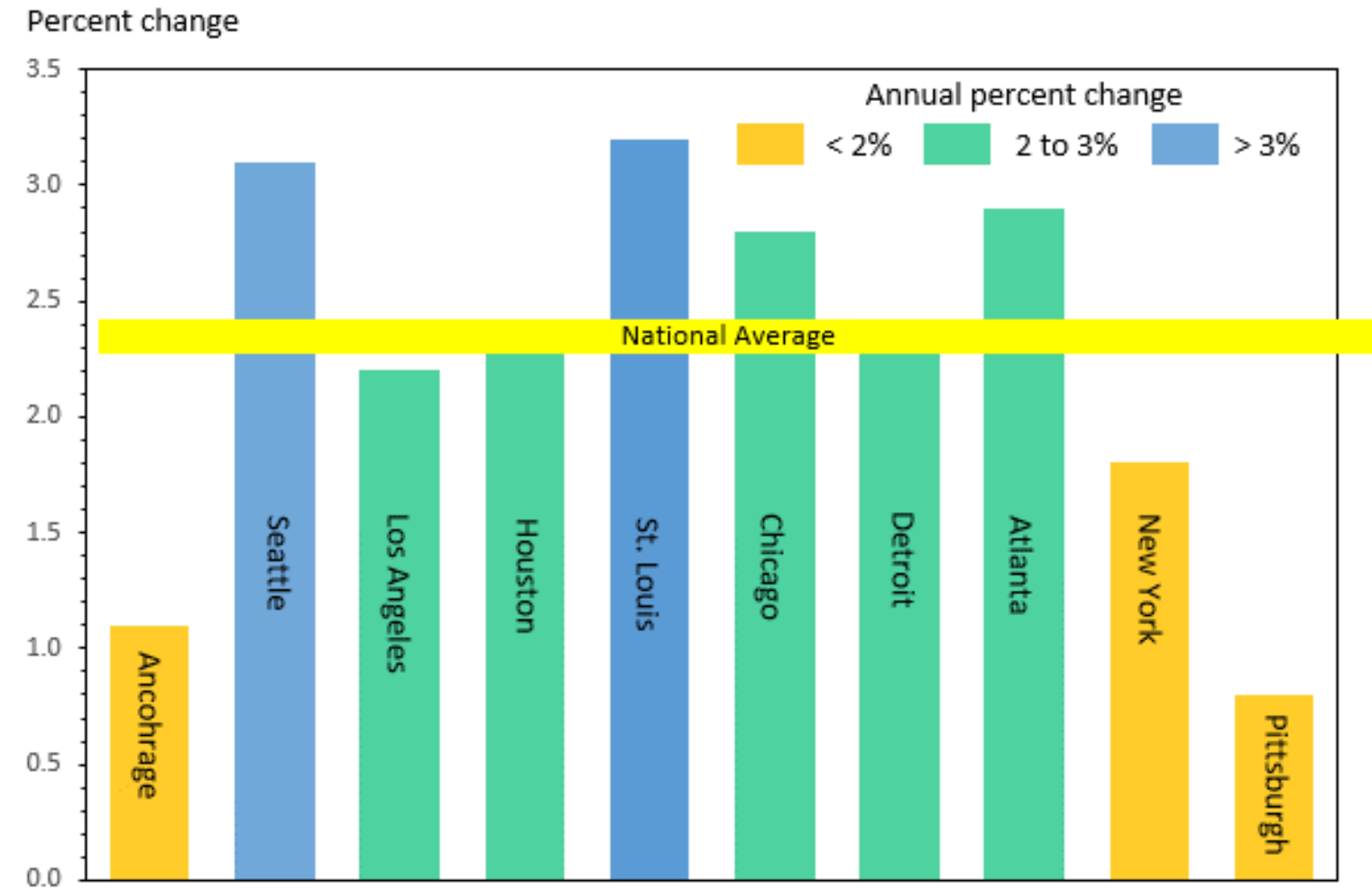
A step-by-step redesign



Nicholas Lowthorpe

Annual grocery store inflation by city, 2014

In 2014, food price inflation was higher in Seattle, St. Louis, Chicago and Atlanta than in other metropolitan areas

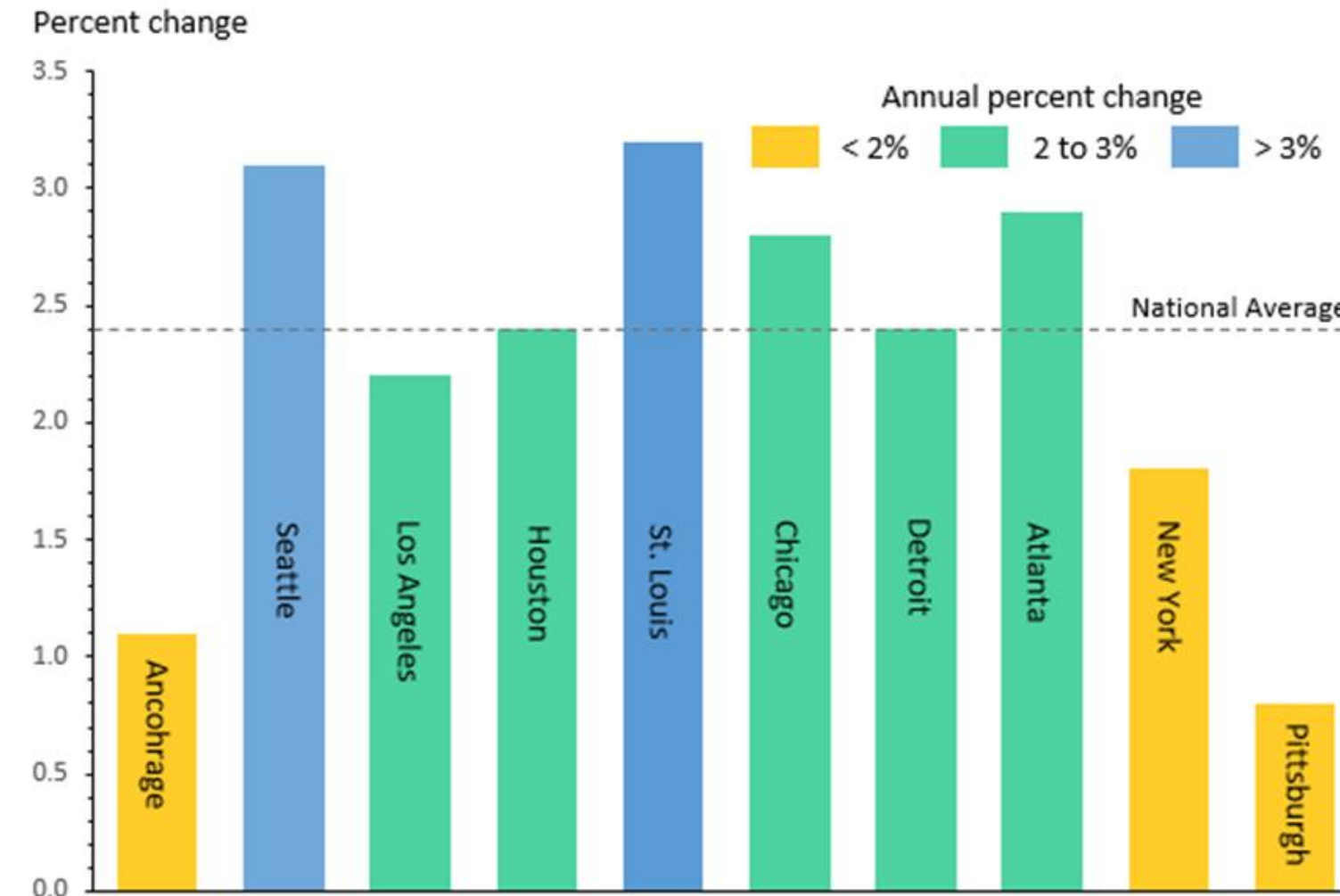


Source: Calculated by ERS, USDA, using Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) data.

- Removed 3D effect.

Annual grocery store inflation by city, 2014

In 2014, food price inflation was higher in Seattle, St. Louis, Chicago and Atlanta than in other metropolitan areas

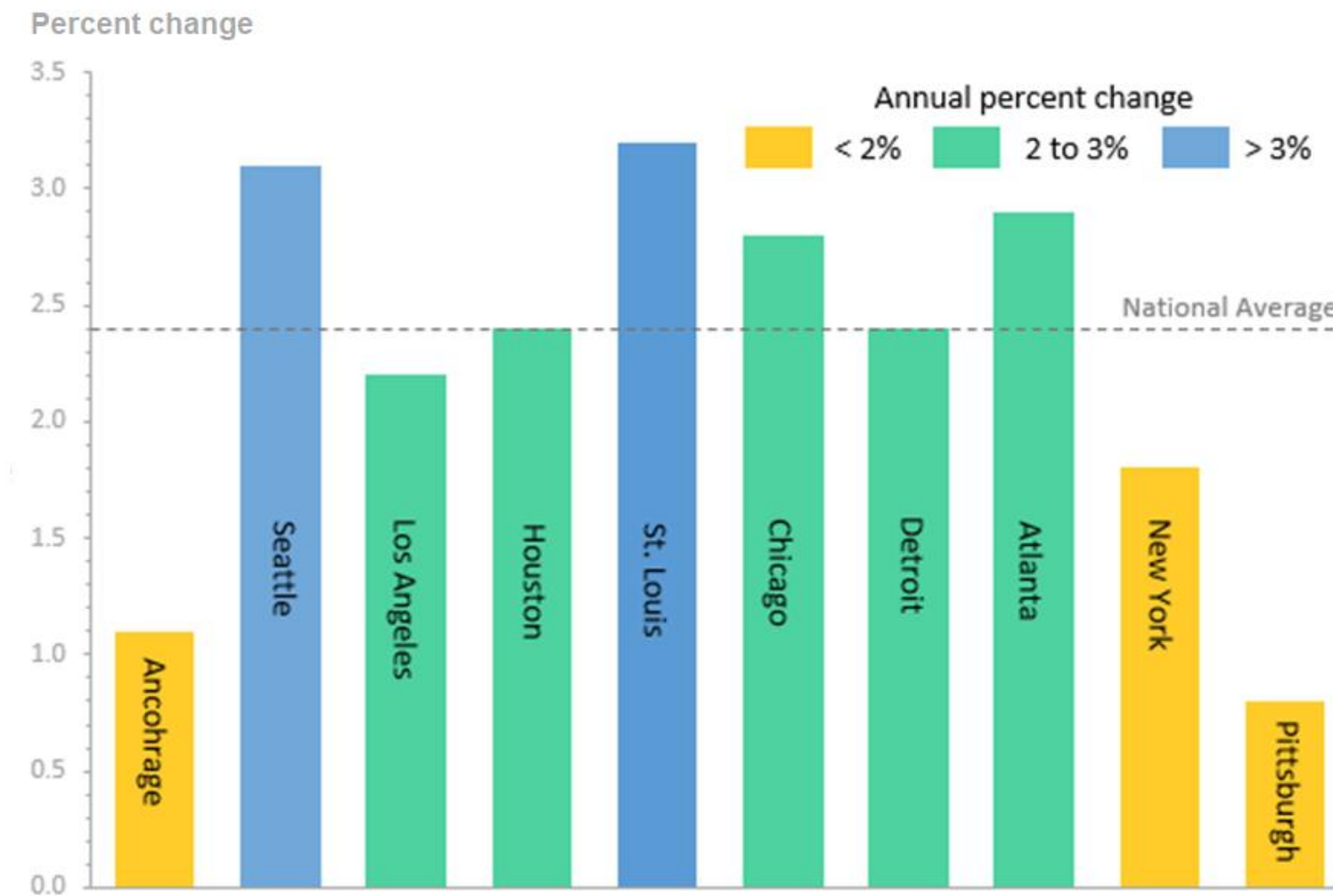


Source: Calculated by ERS, USDA, using Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) data.

- Replaced yellow 'national average' bar with a precise dotted line.
- Removed chart border.

Annual grocery store inflation by city, 2014

In 2014, food price inflation was higher in Seattle, St. Louis, Chicago and Atlanta than in other metropolitan areas



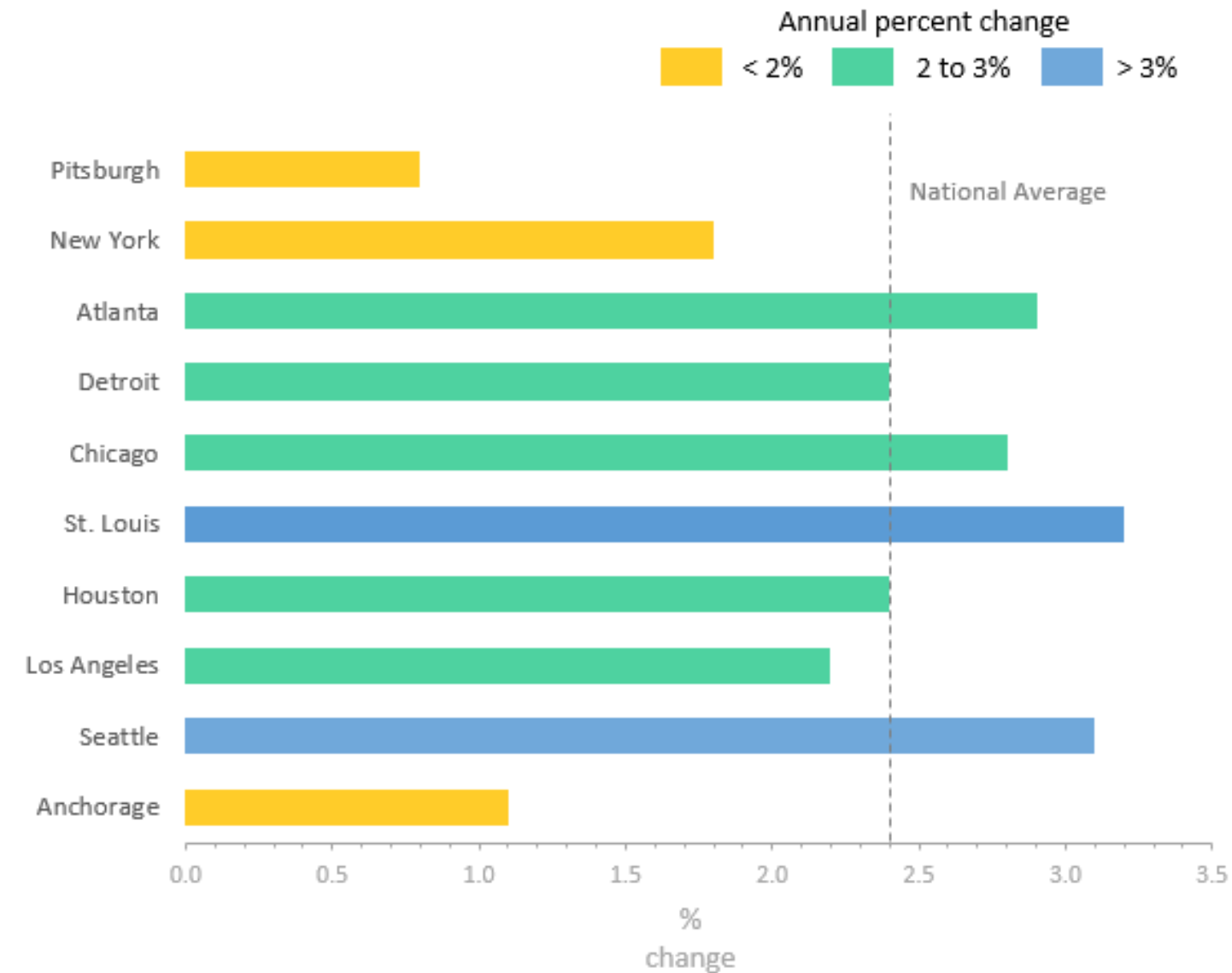
Source: Calculated by ERS, USDA, using Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) data.

- Used grey to suppress axes and source data text, ensuring bars remain the focal point.

Note: greying out the axes here becomes a redundant step later, but I've included it to show how it can be a useful design choice.

Annual grocery store inflation by city, 2014

In 2014, food price inflation was higher in Seattle, St. Louis, Chicago and Atlanta than in other metropolitan areas

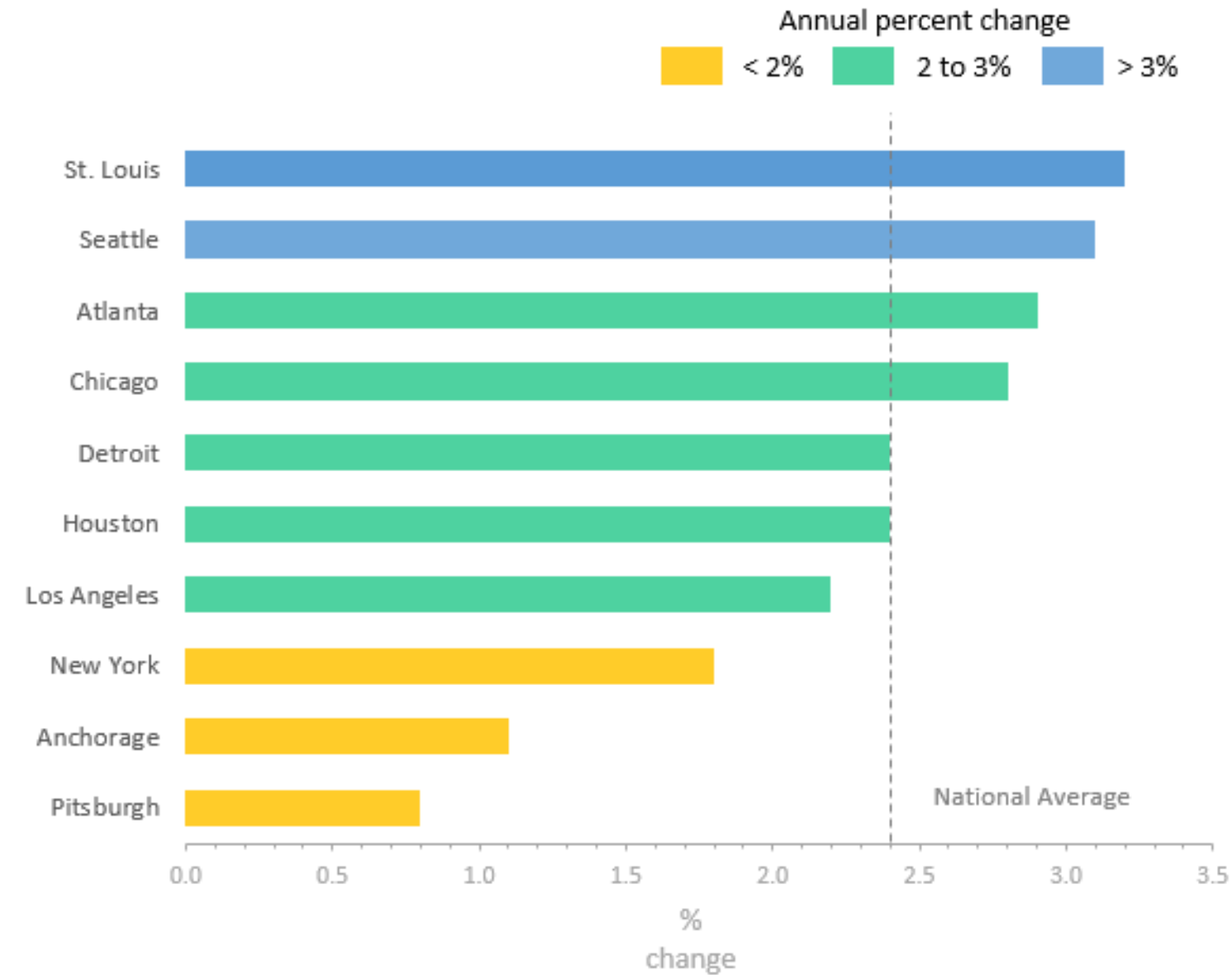


Source: Calculated by ERS, USDA, using Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) data.

- Switched to horizontal bar chart, so the long category labels can be read without tilting the neck.
- Notice there's no axis line at the bar origin: the negative space between the right-justified category labels and bars creates a natural line

Annual grocery store inflation by city, 2014

In 2014, food price inflation was higher in Seattle, St. Louis, Chicago and Atlanta than in other metropolitan areas

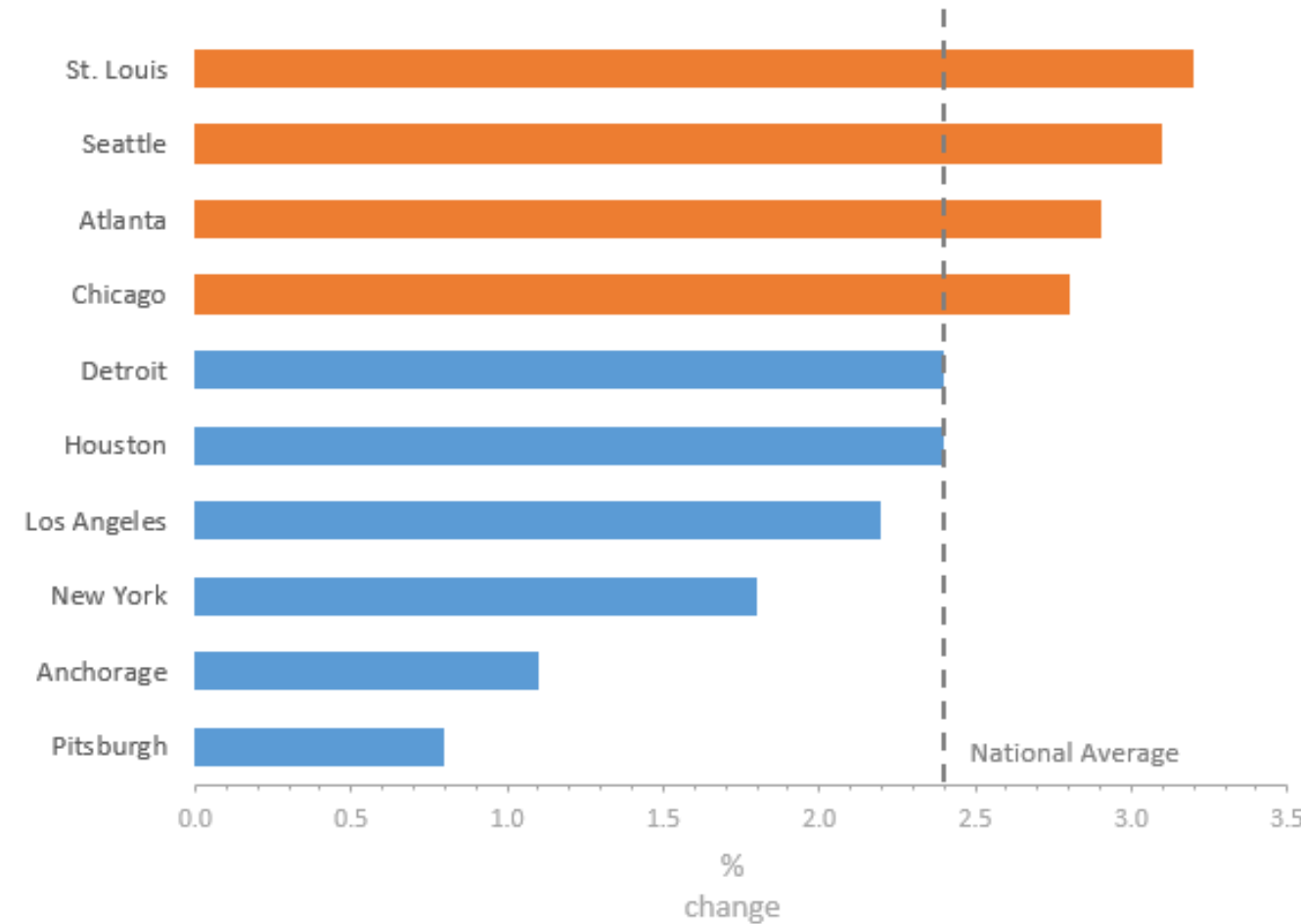


Source: Calculated by ERS, USDA, using Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) data.

- The title of the graph emphasises the comparison of inflation, so the bars have been ordered accordingly.

Annual grocery store inflation by city, 2014

In 2014, food price inflation was higher in **St. Louis, Seattle, Atlanta and Chicago** than in **other metropolitan areas**.



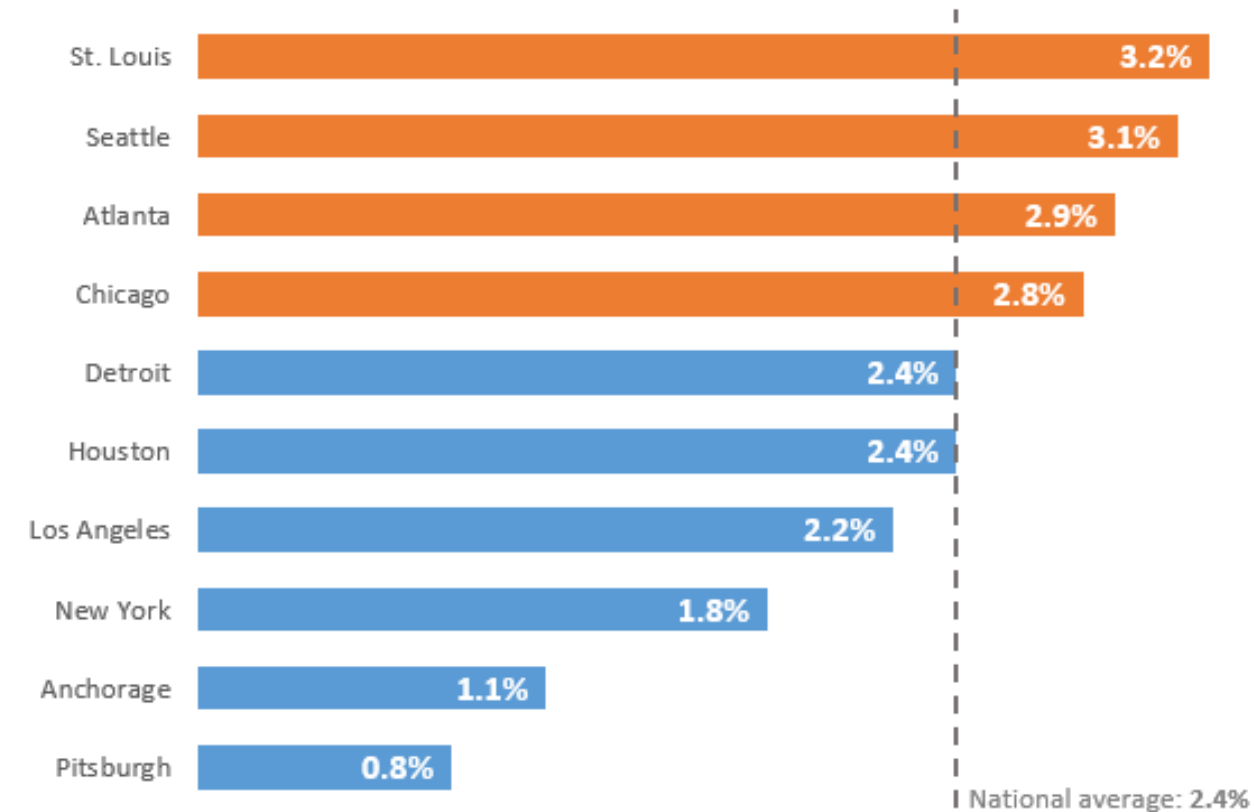
Source: Calculated by ERS, USDA, using Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) data.

- Focused on the message in the title by adjusting to a (colourblind friendly) colour scheme, using colour to link title with chart. I suspect the four named cities are in the title because they're the ones above national average.
- Removed the legend as I could find no contextual information indicating the significance of these buckets.

NOTE: This choice may not be consistent with the original author's intentions and message – it's just a guess to illustrate some design principles.

Annual grocery store inflation by city, 2014

In 2014, food price inflation was higher in **St. Louis, Seattle, Atlanta and Chicago** than in **other metropolitan areas**.

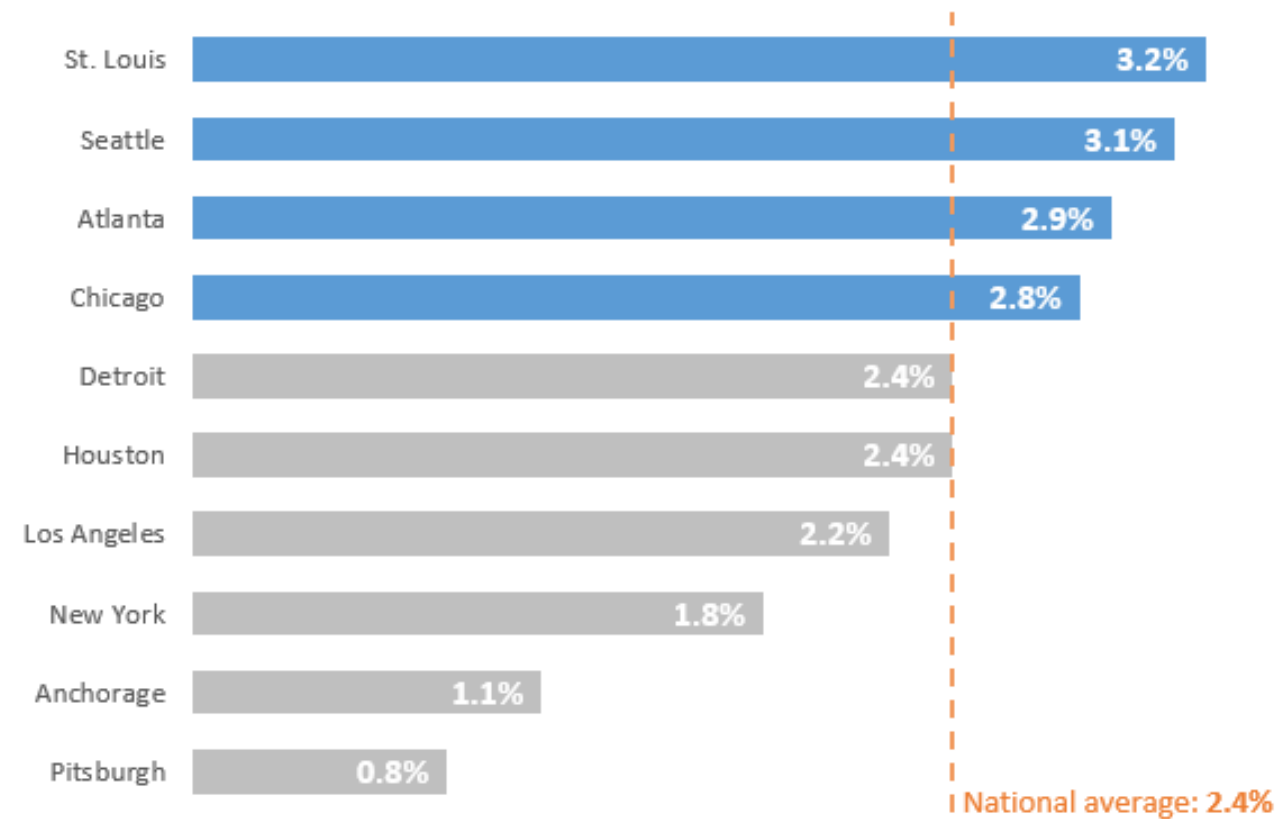


Source: Calculated by ERS, USDA, using Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) data.

- A final declutter step: removed the remaining axes and integrating values into the chart itself.
- What other stories could we focus on using the same chart and data?

Annual grocery store inflation by city, 2014

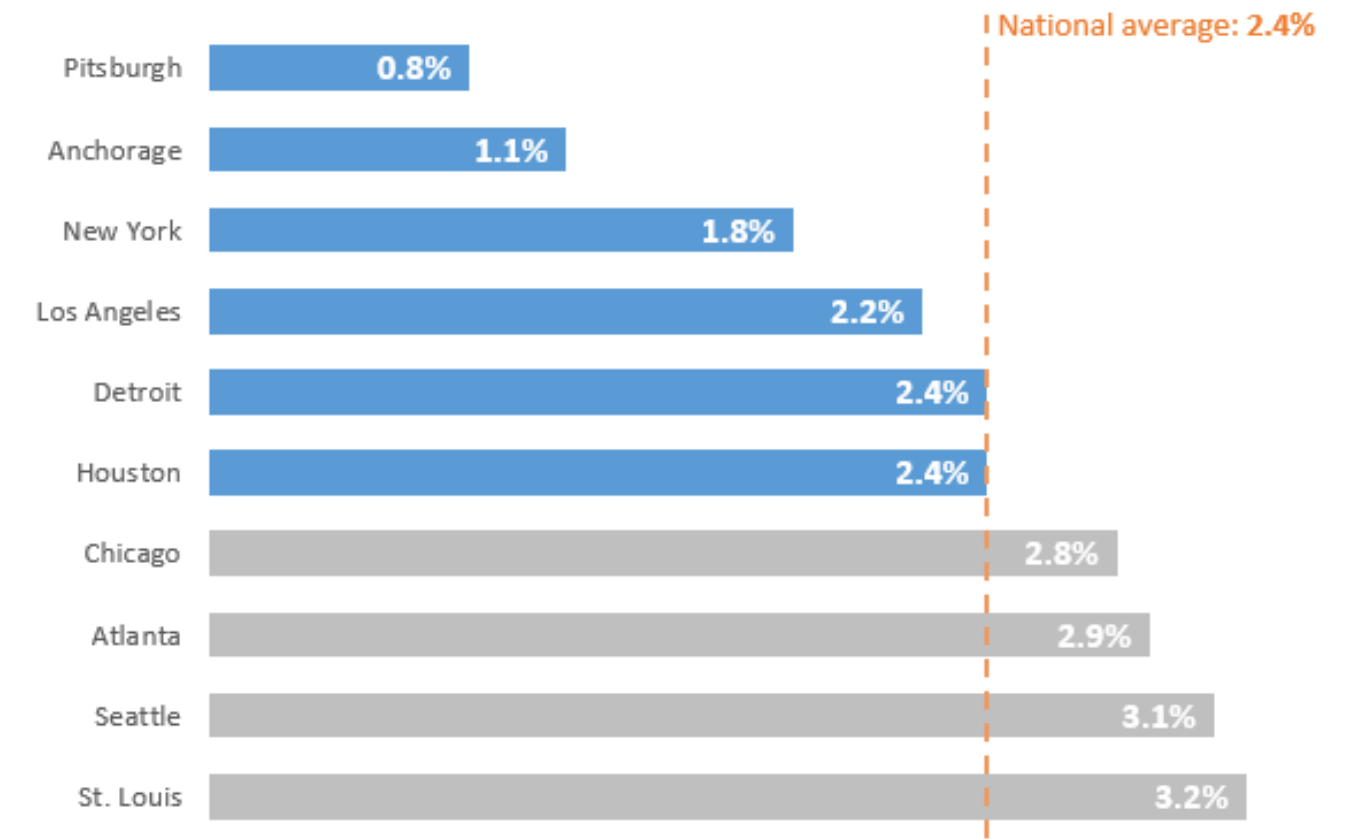
In 2014, food price inflation was above the **national average** in **St. Louis, Seattle, Atlanta and Chicago**.



Source: Calculated by ERS, USDA, using Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) data.

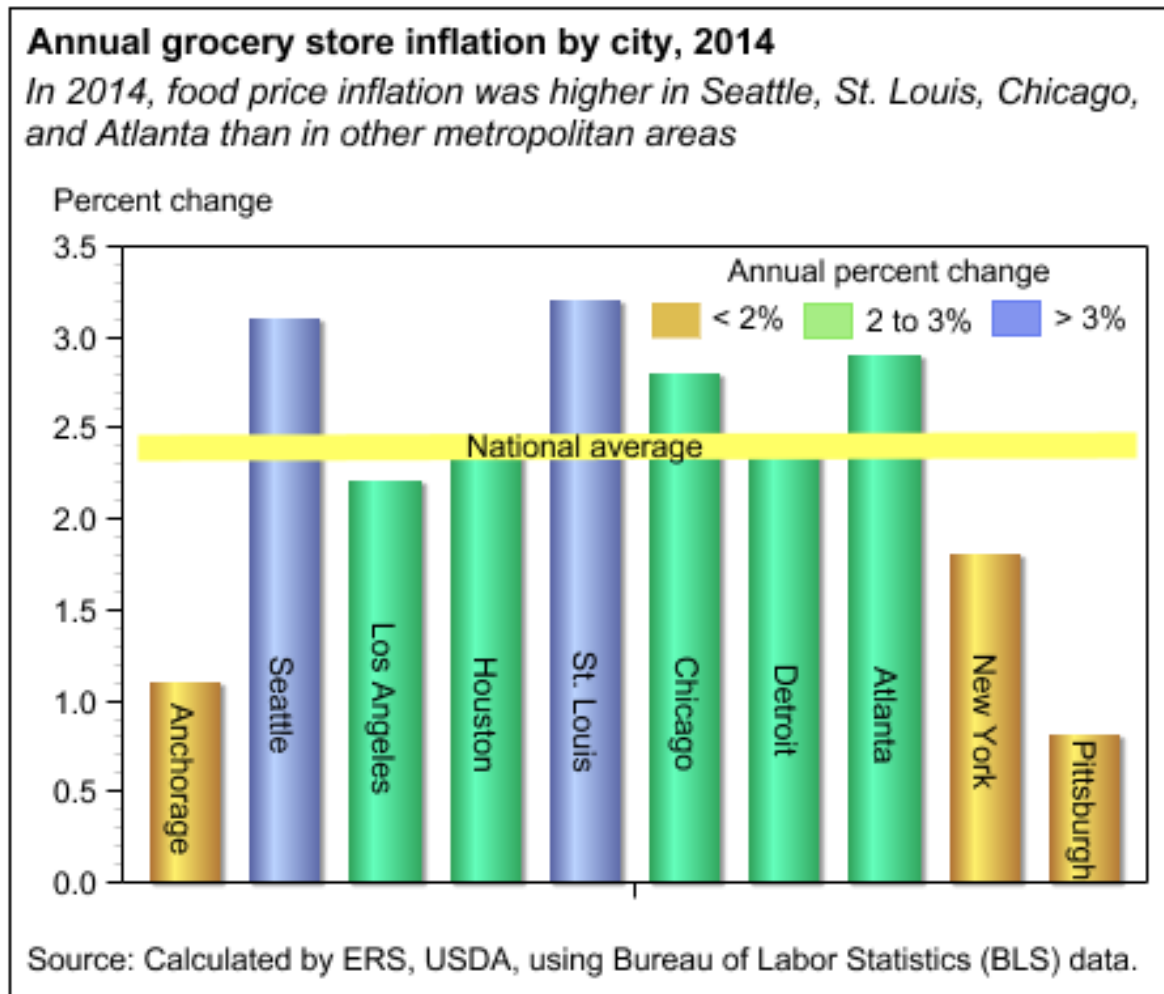
Annual grocery store inflation by city, 2014

In 2014, food price inflation was below the **national average** in **six major cities**.



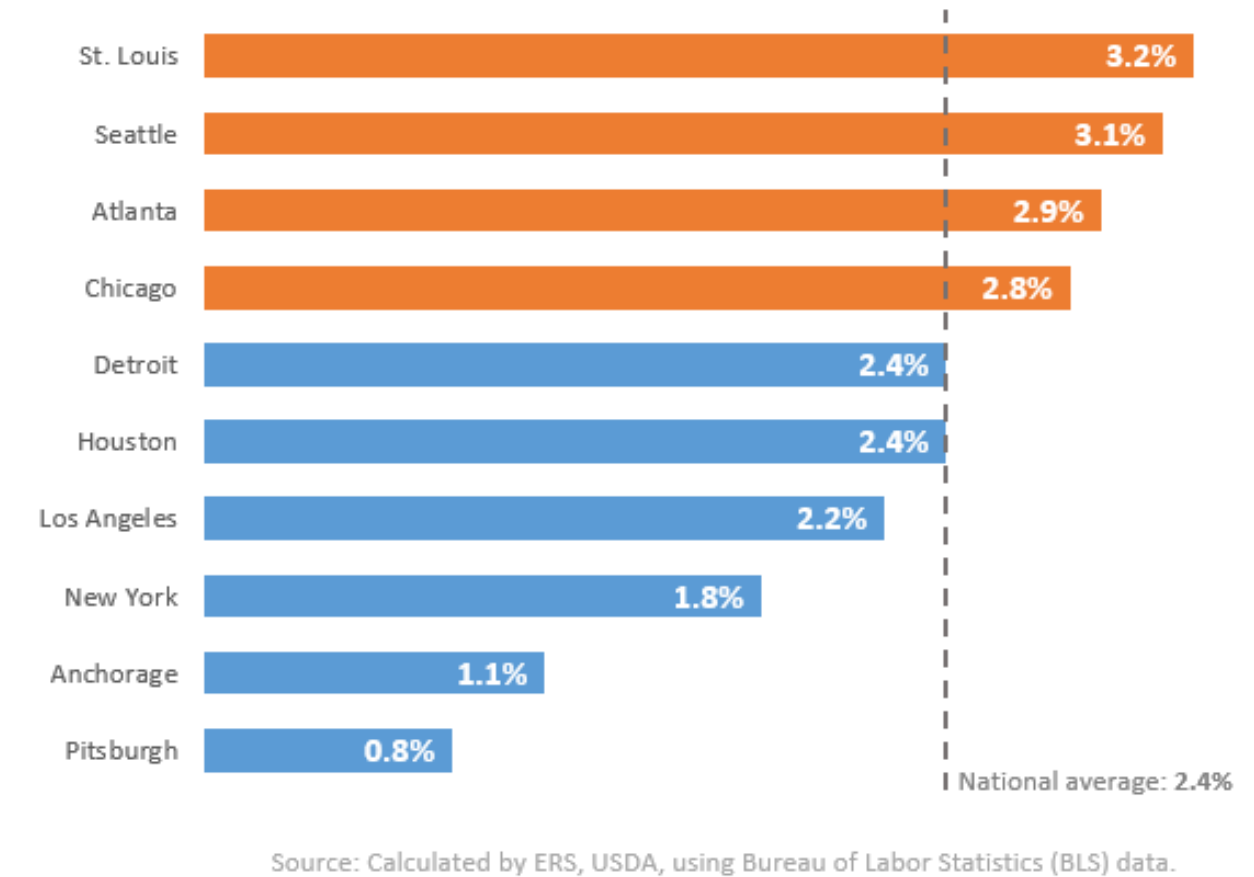
Source: Calculated by ERS, USDA, using Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) data.

- Here's two other versions using the same principles.



Annual grocery store inflation by city, 2014

In 2014, food price inflation was higher in **St. Louis, Seattle, Atlanta and Chicago** than in **other metropolitan areas**.



What do you think of the redesign? Let me know any thoughts in the comments!